

MODDABLE CHESS · VARIANT 149 OF 155

# Turkish Great Chess IV

**14×14**

BOARD

**2**

PLAYERS

# TURKISH GREAT CHESS IV

Turkish Great Chess, Variation IV is a historical large chess variant played on a 14×14 board. Although catalogued under Turkish chess by John Gollon from H. J. R. Murray's *A History of Chess*, it uses Indian piece names (Raja, Rani) and Persian names (Shahzadeh) alongside the standard Arabic-derived names, suggesting a mixed cultural origin.

A notable feature: the **Rani (Queen)** is unusually weak — moving only one square in any direction like a King — and may be deliberately placed or left on an attacked square without being considered in check. This makes the Rani tactically sacrificeable.

## THE BOARD

14×14 (196 squares). Uncoloured in the original; shown checkered on chessvariants.com for clarity.

## STARTING POSITION

**Rank 1 (White):**

| SQUARE | PIECE              |
|--------|--------------------|
| a1     | Rook               |
| b1     | Ghora (Knight)     |
| c1     | Dahja (Standard)   |
| d1     | Ratha (Chariot)    |
| e1     | Fil (Elephant)     |
| f1     | Shahzadeh (Prince) |
| g1     | Wazir              |
| h1     | Raja (King)        |
| i1     | Rani (Queen)       |
| j1     | Fil (Elephant)     |
| k1     | Ratha (Chariot)    |
| l1     | Dahja (Standard)   |
| m1     | Ghora (Knight)     |
| n1     | Rook               |
| a2–n2  | Pawns (14 pieces)  |

**Black:** mirror on ranks 14 and 13.

## PIECES

| PIECE     | NAME(S)          | MOVEMENT                                               | COUNT       |
|-----------|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Raja      | King             | As King in chess                                       | 1 per side  |
| Rani      | Queen            | 1 square in any direction; may be placed/left en prise | 1 per side  |
| Shahzadeh | Prince           | As Bishop or Rook (= Chancellor without Knight)        | 1 per side  |
| Wazir     | Vizir / Minister | As Bishop or Rook                                      | 1 per side  |
| Fil       | Elephant         | As Bishop                                              | 2 per side  |
| Ratha     | Chariot          | As Rook                                                | 2 per side  |
| Dahja     | Standard         | As Bishop                                              | 2 per side  |
| Ghora     | Horse            | As Knight                                              | 2 per side  |
| Rook      | —                | As Rook                                                | 2 per side  |
| Pawn      | —                | As Pawn (no double first move)                         | 14 per side |

## KEY PIECE NOTES

**Rani:** Unlike the standard chess Queen, the Rani moves only one square in any direction. Uniquely, she **may be placed or left en prise** — the opponent is not required to capture her, and she cannot be used to deliver checkmate in the traditional sense. This makes her more of a positional piece than a royal one.

**Shahzadeh and Wazir:** Both move as Bishop or Rook — together they form a powerful slider pair.

## RULES

- ♦ No castling
- ♦ Pawns have no double first move
- ♦ Stalemate and bare King rules unknown from historical sources
- ♦ Pawn promotion: reaches last rank and promotes to Wazir
- ♦ Win: Checkmate the opponent's Raja

## ATTRIBUTION

Turkish Great Chess, Variation IV. John Gollon's version, sourced from H. J. R. Murray's *A History of Chess*. Documented by John Ayer on [chessvariants.com/large.dir/greatchessiv.html](https://chessvariants.com/large.dir/greatchessiv.html).